Murder Mystery

Dinner Party 2026



Claire O’Scuro

The Meridian Museum

October 30, 2026 / Private player packet / 1 of 12

INTRODUCTIONS

Claire O'Scuro

Chief Curator of World Cultures

Claire can identify a fifteenth-century glaze at twenty paces and a crooked label from the parking lot. Claire is the intellectual engine behind Treasures of the World: brilliant, exacting, and visibly pained by sloppy labels, bad lighting, and people who call every old object an 'artifact.' She has spent years building the Meridian's scholarly reputation and knows the exhibition better than anyone alive.

- Works alongside **Artie Ficial**. They usually agree on the collection and argue about the gala.
- Mentors **Reed DeLabel**, who still sends draft labels for approval.
- Consults **Chip Patina** and **Dr. Art E. Fact** when an object needs closer examination.
- **Anne E. Dote** turns Claire's research into gallery tours. Claire keeps restoring the words **Anne** simplifies.

ACTING TIPS

Controlled, observant, skeptical, extremely competitive. You do not need to be loud; a raised eyebrow can do half the work.

YOUR INTRODUCTION / READ THE BOX ALOUD

> I'm Claire O'Scuro. I am delighted to meet anyone who knows the difference between provenance and a price tag.

Continue to your private briefing on page 3. Keep the packet facing you.

Claire O’Scuro

Tips for a Successful Dinner

What's at Stake

She trained Reed to trust her judgment and now fears she has taught obedience instead of scholarship.

Best Practices

- Everyone, including you, has something to hide, something at stake. But only one guest tonight is guilty of murder.
- Mingle using the relationships on your introduction page. Feel free to improvise in conversations.
- If a named guest is absent, simply speak to someone else. Not everyone made it to the gala tonight.
- By now, you should have drawn a secret animal. Memorize it and don’t share it with anyone. This animal is YOUR key to knowing whether you are the murderer or innocent tonight. This will tell you which sections of this packet you can read out loud.
- When asked to read from this packet, please read the appropriate box as written. Feel free to add your own flair to stay in character.
- Don't let anyone else see what's in your packet!



STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.

Claire O'Scuro

The Game is Afoot

The Meridian Museum has its share of secrets, rumors, and lost paperwork. Sixteen numbered envelopes are hidden around the museum. Their contents may significantly help you tonight. These 3 hints lead to 3 different hiding places. If you find an envelope, bring it to your seat at the table. The guest with the most envelopes will win a special prize. You may investigate together.

1 *A life of resistance, written about a German theologian, shelters another secret.*

2 *Flowers would call this home; tonight paperwork has moved in.*

3 *The cars have an entrance. The secret sits above its door.*

STOP **STOP! Do not turn the page yet.**
Wait for the host to announce the next round.

Questions for the Room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 6, then choose the next guest.

Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Sue Venir

What would Grant's terms change for the museum or your family?

Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Dr. Art E. Fact / Reed DeLabel

What problem in the collection work could Grant use against you?

Vincent Van Faux / Elon Mosaic / Penny Pincher

What dispute did your dealings with Grant leave you hiding?

Frank Lloyd Wrong / Elle Loominate / Al Baster / Anne E. Dote

What would Grant change about your commission or public program?

Paige Turner / Mona Lott / Robin Banks / Justin Tyme

What did Grant want made public, and what did you not want made public?

Dada DiCapo / Barb Dwyer / Brie DeVivre / Cary Crates

What did Grant expect you to deliver, and why did that put you in trouble?

Your speaking box is on page 6. Turn only within this act.

Claire O'Scuro

Your Answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you. After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

IF INNOCENT

> The bowl's ownership papers were incomplete. I approved its label too soon; Grant preferred that earlier version. Reed kept asking me to revisit it. I taught that student to question an authority, and then behaved very badly when the authority was me. Grant wanted my name beneath the claim tonight. I wanted the revised label up. We were each rather determined.

IF MURDERER

> The bowl's ownership papers were incomplete. I approved its label too soon; Grant retained my signature. Reed kept asking me to revisit it. Grant could expose the earlier approval whenever I objected to his claim. My department was meant to thank him tonight. Instead I was trying to withdraw authority he already possessed, with my student watching.

STOP

STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.

Questions for the Room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 8, then choose the next guest.

Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Sue Venir

What did you change about the announcement, accounts or private arrangements?

Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Dr. Art E. Fact / Reed DeLabel

What did you change, handle or keep from the incoming loans and their paperwork?

Vincent Van Faux / Elon Mosaic / Penny Pincher

What did you keep out of the handout, demonstration or publicity?

Frank Lloyd Wrong / Elle Loominate / Al Baster / Anne E. Dote

What did you change when the installation and gala plans were disputed?

Paige Turner / Mona Lott / Robin Banks / Justin Tyme

What did you record, circulate or give to the people at the gala?

Dada DiCapo / Barb Dwyer / Brie DeVivre / Cary Crates

What did you do about the performance, privacy or private service?

Your speaking box is on page 8. Turn only within this act.

Claire O'Scuro

Your Answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you. After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

IF INNOCENT

I removed the bowl's ownership label. The bowl remained. Reed kept the old wording. I moved the bottle's incoming papers from the public display file to intake because its approval was on hold. Both files were on that desk. Reed, please stop calling everything I did a correction. Some of it was simply putting an unpleasant decision where I would not have to look at it.

IF MURDERER

I removed the bowl's ownership label; Reed kept the old wording. The bottle's papers went to intake because approval was on hold. Grant wanted the explanation brought to him personally. I put his copy beside the glass at his place. He was elsewhere. I remember moving the glass to keep its damp base off the paper. Such a small, fussy thing to remember. Reed, I was angry enough to let him wait for his explanation afterward.

STOP

STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.

Questions for the Room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 10, then choose the next guest.

Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Sue Venir

What happened to the toast and the announcement?

Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Dr. Art E. Fact / Reed DeLabel

What was actually on display, and what had your department been told?

Vincent Van Faux / Elon Mosaic / Penny Pincher

What do you know about the bottle, pictures, or technology you brought tonight?

Frank Lloyd Wrong / Elle Loominate / Al Baster / Anne E. Dote

Could the work or the tour have hidden what happened?

Paige Turner / Mona Lott / Robin Banks / Justin Tyme

What part of the story have your sources left out?

Dada DiCapo / Barb Dwyer / Brie DeVivre / Cary Crates

What did people actually see, hear, and drink?

Your speaking box is on page 10. Turn only within this act.

Claire O'Scuro

Your Answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you. After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

IF INNOCENT

> Intake had the seller's terms, the contents query and the warning to keep it closed. Moving the papers didn't withdraw that warning. Reed asked me to stop the preview until we had an answer. I sent another query. Yes, Reed. I heard you the first time.

IF MURDERER

> I checked the intake sheet myself. Empty. That is what I authorized and what went onto the preview stand. There were no original contents there to take. Reed, bring the receiving copy. I'm answering for my approval, not for a bottle someone now says was full.

The shared discoveries and reports remain at the Evidence Table.

STOP

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BALLOT

Claire O’Scuro

Choose one attending guest. Explain your accusation in your own words. Detach this page and give only the ballot to the host for tallying. Keep your packet for Coming Clean.

I accuse...

Because...

Best Actor

Best Costume

Claire O'Scuro

The Last Word

Read only when the host calls you. Top three suspects read first. Use your own role's box; keep every other word private.

IF INNOCENT / READ ALOUD WHEN CALLED

I did not kill Grant. Intake retained the unanswered contents question and the closed-bottle restriction. I left the preview approved anyway. My earlier bowl label was also wrong. Reed, you should not have needed my permission to keep asking. I cannot offer you a corrected label as an apology for that. I can offer you the original file, and I can stop standing between you and it.

IF MURDERER / READ ALOUD WHEN CALLED

The incoming sheet does not say empty. It says inert display liquid, on Grant's word. I moved the papers because I did not want that distinction examined. I took poison from the bottle during the preview and later put it in his waiting glass. I used my authority over intake to make the source sound harmless and nonexistent. My label correction was real. Reed, you were right to question me. I have spent tonight making you ashamed of the person who taught you to do that.

Every selected suspect gets their final word.